

Qroo Paul's Spanish Master Course

Lesson 37 Summary

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In this lesson, Paul introduces the **future tense in Spanish**—how it works, how to conjugate it, and when to use it. He also reviews two other patterns you've already learned that Spanish speakers commonly use to talk about the future.

1. Three Ways to Talk About the Future in Spanish

Spanish offers **three main tools** for talking about future events. You've already been using two of them in previous lessons:

A. IR + a + infinitive (Going to do something)

This structure mirrors English and is easy to use:

- *Voy a estudiar mañana.* = I'm going to study tomorrow.
- *Vamos a viajar a España.* = We're going to travel to Spain.

B. Present tense + time expression

Just like in English, the present tense can express the future if a time reference is included:

- *¿Trabajas mañana?* = Do you work tomorrow?
- *No, trabajo el sábado.* = No, I work on Saturday.

Tip: Use the definite article (*el lunes, el sábado*) to say "on" a day of the week, but **don't** use it when stating what day it is (e.g., *Hoy es domingo*).

C. The Simple Future Tense (Will do something)

This is the focus of the lesson:

- *Hablaré con María.* = I will speak with María.
- *Comerán tarde.* = They will eat late.

It's a simple and natural way to express what **will** happen, and it's easier to conjugate than most other tenses.

2. Polite Requests: Don't Use the Future Tense

In English, we often use the future tense to make polite requests:

- *Will you bring me another napkin?*

But in Spanish, that sounds awkward. Spanish speakers typically use the **present tense** for polite questions like:

– *¿Me traes otra servilleta, por favor?* = Will you bring me another napkin, please?

Even though it looks like present tense, it's understood as polite depending on tone and context. You can add *por favor* or *¿sí?* to soften it even more.

3. A Special Use: Expressing Probability or Guessing

Spanish uses the future tense in a way that differs from English: to make guesses or assumptions.

This is roughly equivalent to *might* or *I wonder* in English.

Examples:

– *¿Quién será?* = Who might that be?

– *Estará en casa.* = He's probably at home.

– *Tendrán unos 40 años.* = They're probably about 40 years old.

This usage is not essential for beginners, but it's good to recognize it when you see or hear it.

4. How to Conjugate the Future Tense

The future tense is one of the **easiest** to conjugate in Spanish:

- You don't remove the -AR, -ER, or -IR endings.
- You simply **add the endings** to the full infinitive.

Endings (Latin American Spanish only):

- **yo:** é
- **tú:** ás
- **él / ella / usted:** á
- **nosotros:** emos (*no accent*)
- **ellos / ellas / ustedes:** án

Examples:

– *hablaré* = I will speak

– *comerás* = You will eat

– *vivirá* = He/She will live

- *iremos* = We will go
- *tendrán* = They will have

Tip: The accent mark shows where to stress the word (e.g., *estudiarás* = es-tu-di-a-RÁS).

5. Irregular Verbs in the Future Tense

Some verbs have irregular stems, but the endings stay the same. Most are verbs you've already seen behave irregularly in other tenses.

Examples:

- *tener* → *tendré*
- *salir* → *saldrás*
- *decir* → *dirá*
- *hacer* → *haré*

Paul recommends using the downloadable PDF chart to practice these irregulars a few at a time.

Final Thoughts

You now have **three reliable ways** to talk about the future:

1. *IR + a + infinitive* = I'm going to do something
2. *Present tense + time expression* = I do something tomorrow
3. *Simple future tense* = I will do something

Stick with the patterns that feel natural to you, and don't be afraid to mix them. You're building real conversational range.